
Together Against
HIV
Get Assistance

About HIV

HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus)

is a virus that attacks the body's immune system, specifically the white blood cells that fight infections. Over time, HIV can weaken the immune system, making it harder for the body to protect itself from diseases. Without proper treatment, HIV can develop into AIDS (Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome).

How it spreads

HIV spreads through contact with certain body fluids of an infected person. The most common ways include:

- Unprotected sexual contact
- Sharing needles or syringes
- Transmission from mother to baby during birth or breastfeeding
- Blood transfusion from unscreened donors (rare today)

Effects on Health

When HIV is left untreated, it damages the immune system, leaving the body vulnerable to infections and certain cancers. However, with early diagnosis and consistent treatment, people living with HIV can lead long, healthy, and fulfilling lives. Raising awareness helps reduce stigma and encourages testing and treatment.

Statistics

In Malaysia, HIV remains a serious health concern.

- More than 100,000 Malaysians are currently living with HIV.
- Most new infections occur through sexual transmission.
- Awareness campaigns and early testing have significantly reduced new cases compared to the past decade.

An estimated 40.8 million [37.0–45.6 million] people were living with HIV at the end of 2024, of which

- 1.4 million [1.1–1.8 million] children (0–14 years old).
- 39.4 [35.7–44.0 million] adults (15+ years old).

Why Statistics Matter

Understanding HIV data helps communities take effective action.

Tracking infection rates, treatment success, and awareness levels helps guide prevention strategies and support services. Each statistic represents real people — awareness and education save lives.

HIV Treatment

There is no cure for HIV, but medicine can control it.
Treatment helps lower the virus and keeps the immune system strong.
People who take medicine correctly can live long and healthy lives.

Antiretroviral Therapy (ART)

The main treatment for HIV is called ART.
It uses a mix of medicines that:

- Stop the virus from growing
- Protect the immune system
- Reduce the chance of spreading HIV

ART must be taken every day to work well.

Living with HIV

With treatment, HIV can be managed.
Regular check-ups and support help people stay healthy and positive.
HIV treatment gives hope and a better quality of life.



Support and Helpliness

If you or someone you know needs help or advice about HIV, reach out to:
Ministry of Health Malaysia (MOH) – 03-8883 4003
Malaysian AIDS Council (MAC) – www.mac.org.my
PT Foundation Helpline – 03-4047 5532

Learn More

Find trusted information from these websites:

- World Health Organization (WHO) – www.who.int/hiv
- UNAIDS – www.unaids.org
- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) – www.cdc.gov/hiv

Community Awareness

Join local programs or awareness campaigns in your area.
Sharing knowledge helps reduce stigma and supports people living with HIV.
Together, we build a caring and informed community.